



THE MIDNIGHT VISITOR

English - Class 10 | Complete Comprehensive Study Notes

Author: Robert Arthur

About the Author:

Robert Arthur was an American writer and editor known for mystery, suspense, and detective-style fiction. His stories often use clever twists, tension, and sharp dialogue instead of unnecessary action. In **“The Midnight Visitor”**, he presents a secret agent who wins not through physical strength, but through intelligence, calmness, and quick thinking.

1. Themes and Values

Theme:

- The victory of **intelligence and presence of mind** over violence and physical strength.
- The difference between appearance and reality: a true secret agent may not look glamorous or heroic.
- Calm thinking during danger can solve problems that force cannot solve.
- Clever deception can be used positively when it prevents harm and protects important information.

- Real courage is quiet, controlled, and practical, not loud or showy.

Values:

- Stay calm in crisis; panic gives power to the enemy.
- Use intelligence before aggression because strategy is often stronger than force.
- Do not judge people only by looks or personality; real ability may be hidden.
- Presence of mind and observation can save lives in dangerous situations.
- Confidence, timing, and clear communication are powerful tools.

2. Characters

- **Ausable:** A secret agent who does not look like the usual heroic spy. He is fat, calm, and ordinary-looking, but extremely intelligent. His quick thinking saves him from danger without physical fighting.
- **Fowler:** A young writer who wants to meet a real secret agent and collect material for his stories. He expects danger, mystery, and adventure, but at first feels disappointed by Ausable's ordinary appearance.
- **Max:** A rival secret agent who enters Ausable's room with a pistol. He wants to steal an important report, but he is defeated by Ausable's clever lie about the balcony.
- **Henry:** The waiter who knocks at Ausable's door with drinks. His ordinary knock becomes the final trigger in Ausable's plan, making Max believe that the police have arrived.

3. Detailed Summary

“**The Midnight Visitor**” is a suspenseful story about a secret agent named **Ausable**. It breaks the usual image of a spy. Ausable is not slim, stylish, or physically impressive; he is fat, calm, and ordinary-looking. But the story proves that a real secret agent's greatest strength is intelligence, courage, and presence of mind.

The story begins with **Fowler**, a young writer, meeting **Ausable** in a hotel in Paris. Fowler expects a thrilling spy life filled with danger, guns, coded messages, and dramatic action. Instead, he finds Ausable living in a small hotel room and looking very ordinary, so he feels disappointed at first.

Ausable understands Fowler's disappointment but does not try to act heroic. He simply tells Fowler that things may become interesting soon because an important secret report is expected that night. The report contains sensitive information, and other agents may try to steal it.

When Ausable and Fowler enter the hotel room, they find **Max** standing inside with a pistol. Max is a rival secret agent who has come to take the report. Fowler is shocked because the danger he imagined has suddenly become real. Since Max has the gun, he appears to control the situation.

Ausable, however, remains completely calm. Instead of panicking or fighting, he behaves as if Max's presence is only an irritation. He complains about the hotel and says that the management has still not blocked the balcony outside his window. In reality, there is no balcony, but Max does not know this.

Ausable speaks with such confidence that Max believes the lie. He also says that someone had entered his room earlier through that balcony, which makes the story sound natural. By doing this, Ausable quietly plants the idea of an escape route in Max's mind.

Soon there is a knock at the door. Ausable quickly uses this moment and says that it must be the police, whom he had arranged for extra protection because the report was important. Actually, the knock is only from **Henry**, the waiter, who has brought drinks, but Max believes Ausable's second lie too.

Frightened by the thought of the police, Max moves towards the window and jumps out, thinking he will land on the balcony. But there is no balcony, so he falls. The danger ends without Ausable using a weapon or physical force. His calm mind, clever words, and perfect timing defeat an armed enemy.

When Henry enters with the drinks, Fowler finally understands Ausable's brilliance. There were no police and no balcony; the whole plan was created

instantly to confuse Max. Fowler learns that real heroism is not about looks or drama. It is about staying calm, thinking fast, and acting with precision during danger.

4. Key Points

- **Fowler** expects a glamorous spy life, but finds **Ausable** ordinary-looking and unimpressive at first.
- **Max** enters Ausable's room with a pistol to steal an important report.
- **Ausable** invents a false story about a balcony outside the window.
- A knock at the door helps Ausable extend the lie by claiming that the police have arrived.
- **Max** tries to escape through the imaginary balcony and falls, proving that Ausable's intelligence defeated him.
- The story shows that real courage is calm thinking, not physical show-off.

5. Moral

- Presence of mind can defeat danger more effectively than physical strength.
- Never judge a person's ability by appearance; real talent may be hidden behind ordinary looks.
- Calmness during crisis is a powerful weapon.
- Intelligence, timing, and confidence can turn a dangerous situation in your favour.
- A true professional does not panic; he observes, thinks, and acts with precision.

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